

Label design, not the model, governs the background residual

A catch-all `background` class gives SAM 3 a plausible answer everywhere: the residual is large and indistinguishable from genuine background. Where the vocabulary covers the scene, it is small and easily detected. Panel ① is the cause; ②–⑥ are consequences, each moving as it predicts. n = 2 datasets— the direction is consistent, the functional form is not claimed.

